07-24 第1篇

阅读理解（说明文） How Do Honeybees Make Honey?

① A single spoonful of honey on our morning bread looks simple — golden, sweet, and warm. But the story behind that spoon is much longer and far more interesting than most of us realise. In fact, one jar of honey, 500 grams, is the result of the careful work of **tens of thousands of bees** flying a total distance similar to **three times around the Earth**. How do these tiny insects turn ordinary flower water into something so tasty and, some say, a little magical?

② The journey of honey starts in a flower. At the centre of most flowers is a sweet watery liquid called **nectar**. The flower produces nectar not for people but for insects: if the insect comes for a drink, it also carries a small dust called **pollen** from one flower to another, helping the flower make new seeds. In this quiet deal, both the flower and the insect win. Bees are the most famous nectar lovers.

③ When a worker bee finds a rich flower, it sucks up the nectar with a long tube-shaped mouth. The nectar is kept in a special second stomach called the **honey stomach**. This stomach does not digest the nectar; it simply stores it on the way home. On the way, a clever thing happens: bees have natural chemicals — **enzymes** — in their honey stomach that start to break the sugar in the nectar into simpler sugars. The nectar is slowly beginning to become honey even before the bee gets back.

④ Back at the beehive, the bee does not make honey alone. It passes the nectar, mouth to mouth, to another bee. That bee passes it again, and again, and again. Each time, more water leaves the liquid, and more enzymes are added. Scientists have counted: a drop of nectar may be passed between bees **15 to 20 times** before it is placed into a small wax cell in the hive.

⑤ But the nectar is still too wet to keep. If bees left it that way, it would go bad, just like leftover juice in our kitchen. So the bees use a surprising tool: their wings. Hundreds of bees stand in rows near the wax cells and beat their wings together. This creates a small wind that dries the nectar, bit by bit, until only about **18% water** remains. At this point, the liquid has changed into real honey: thick, slow, and long-lasting.

⑥ When a cell is full of finished honey, the bees seal it with a thin layer of **beeswax**. Like a jar with a tight lid, a sealed cell can keep honey good for many years — archaeologists have even found usable honey in ancient tombs more than 3,000 years old. Honey also has natural substances that stop harmful bacteria from growing. That is why honey rarely spoils and why, for hundreds of years, people have used it to help heal small cuts.

⑦ Bees do all this not to feed us but to feed themselves. A strong hive needs honey to survive the cold months when no flowers bloom. Good beekeepers take only the **extra** honey — the part the bees do not need — and leave enough behind. In recent years, however, the world's bees have faced serious trouble: strange diseases, lost wild flowers, and too many harmful chemicals on farms have caused bee numbers to drop. Without bees, flowers fail, fruits fail, and our breakfast would look very different.

⑧ So the next time a teaspoon of honey slides into your tea, think for a moment about the long, careful journey behind it. From one flower to your cup, it has passed through thousands of tiny wings. The best way to say thank you is not only to enjoy it — but to care, in small ways, for the gardens and wild places where bees still work, quietly, every sunny day.

根据文章内容，选择最佳答案。

1. What is nectar, according to paragraph ②?

A. A kind of insect that lives on flowers.
B. The sweet, watery liquid in the centre of most flowers.
C. A type of honey people make at home.
D. A chemical bees make with their wings.

2. What is the main purpose of the bees' honey stomach?

A. To cook food for the young bees.
B. To store the nectar on the way home, while enzymes begin to break sugar into simpler sugars.
C. To hold water for the queen bee.
D. To help the bee fly faster.

3. How do bees dry the nectar inside the hive?

A. They put it under the sun on a leaf.
B. They pour warm water on it.
C. They stand in rows and beat their wings to create a small wind that removes water until about 18% remains.
D. They leave it open to the rain.

4. Why can sealed honey last for many years without going bad?

A. Because bees add sugar and salt every morning.
B. Because the wax seal keeps air out and honey has natural substances that stop harmful bacteria from growing.
C. Because honey freezes quickly inside the hive.
D. Because honey attracts helpful bacteria.

5. What message does the writer want to give at the end of the passage?

A. Bees are dangerous and should be removed from our gardens.
B. People should stop eating honey completely.
C. Honey is the result of the long, careful work of bees, and we should protect the places where bees live.
D. Honey will replace sugar in every country next year.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第②段 "a sweet watery liquid called nectar."
【解析】花蜜是花中央的甜液体。A/C/D 均错。故选 B。

2.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第③段 "stores it... enzymes... break the sugar..."
【解析】蜜胃储存花蜜并启动酶解。A/C/D 均错。故选 B。

3.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑤段 "beat their wings... until only about 18% water remains."
【解析】用翅膀扇风蒸发水分至 18%。A/B/D 均错。故选 C。

4.
【答案】B
【题型】推理判断题
【定位】第⑥段 "seal it with... beeswax... natural substances that stop harmful bacteria..."
【解析】蜂蜡封口+天然抑菌物。A/C/D 均错。故选 B。

5.
【答案】C
【题型】主旨大意题
【定位】第⑦—⑧段
【解析】结尾呼吁珍惜蜂蜜并保护蜜蜂栖息地。A/B/D 均偏。故选 C。

词汇注释（超纲词）

- **nectar** [n.] 花蜜
- **pollen** [n.] 花粉

- **enzyme** [n.] 酶
- **hive** [n.] 蜂巢
- **beeswax** [n.] 蜂蜡
- **archaeologist** [n.] 考古学家